

Design System & UX

Project name — TBD

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1. Overview & Design Principles

What this product should feel like to use, and the principles that resolve design disputes. Owned by `ux-designer`; spans late-Research (flows, wireframes) through Plan/Implement (the design system matures as screens get built).

- *Principle — e.g. "mobile-first; design up, not down"*
- *Principle — e.g. "accessible by default (WCAG AA)"*
- *Principle — e.g. "no decorative loading states"*

2. Design System

The single source of truth for the visual language. The written spec lives alongside this doc; the machine-readable system lives in the two CSS files that `frontend-lead` consumes directly.

- `design-system-spec.md` — the written spec (token rationale, component inventory, usage rules)
- `tokens.css` — design tokens as CSS custom properties
- `screen.css` — component & screen styles built on the tokens

Figma stays the high-fidelity design tool (via the `ux-designer`'s Figma skills); `docs/DESIGN/` is the in-repo, code-level home that ships with the project and is the contract for implementation.

3. Design Tokens

Color, typography, spacing, radius, shadow, and motion primitives. Edit values in [tokens.css](#); the swatches below preview the live variables.

This palette is based on the shadcn/ui theme preset **Stone · Lime · Amber** — ui.shadcn.com/create?preset=b1FR0Us0w. Tokens use shadcn's own names (so shadcn components drop in unchanged); the `--color-*` aliases in §3.6 are the project-facing names. Both light and dark themes ship — re-theme by swapping values in `tokens.css`.

3.1 Surfaces & Text

--background

--foreground

--card

--card-foreground

--popover

--popover-foreground

--muted

--muted-foreground

3.2 Actions & States

--primary

--primary-foreground

--secondary

--secondary-foreground

--accent

--accent-foreground

--destructive

--destructive-foreground

3.3 Borders & Focus

--border

--input

--ring

3.4 Charts





--chart-1



--chart-2



--chart-3

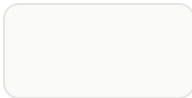


--chart-4



--chart-5

3.5 Sidebar



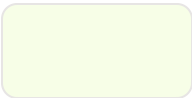
--sidebar



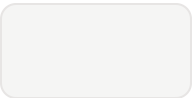
--sidebar-foreground



--sidebar-primary



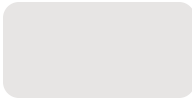
--sidebar-primary-foreground



--sidebar-accent



--sidebar-accent-foreground



--sidebar-border



--sidebar-ring

3.6 Project aliases & scales

The rest of the repo uses these semantic names, mapped onto the shadcn base above.

Project alias	shadcn base	Role
--color-primary / --color-on-primary	--primary / --primary-foreground	Primary actions (buttons, active nav) + text on them
--color-secondary / --color-on-secondary	--secondary / --secondary-foreground	Secondary buttons / chips
--color-surface	--background	Page background / canvas base
--color-surface-raised	--card	Cards, sheets, the doc content card
--color-surface-muted	--muted	Subtle fills — code, table hover
--color-text / --color-text-muted	--foreground / --muted-foreground	Body text / secondary text
--color-border / --color-input / --color-ring	--border / --input / --ring	Hairlines, field borders, focus rings

Project alias	shadcn base	Role
<code>--color-danger</code> / <code>--color-on-danger</code>	<code>--destructive</code> / <code>--destructive-foreground</code>	Errors, destructive actions
<code>--color-success</code> / <code>--color-warning</code> (+ <code>on-</code>)	<i>not in shadcn base</i>	Status states — kept as project roles

Radius: `--radius 0.625rem` → `--radius-sm/md/lg/xl/full`. **Type:** `--font-sans` *Inter*, `--font-mono` *Geist Mono* (self-hosted). Plus `--text-*`, `--space-*`, `--shadow-*`, `--duration-*` scales.

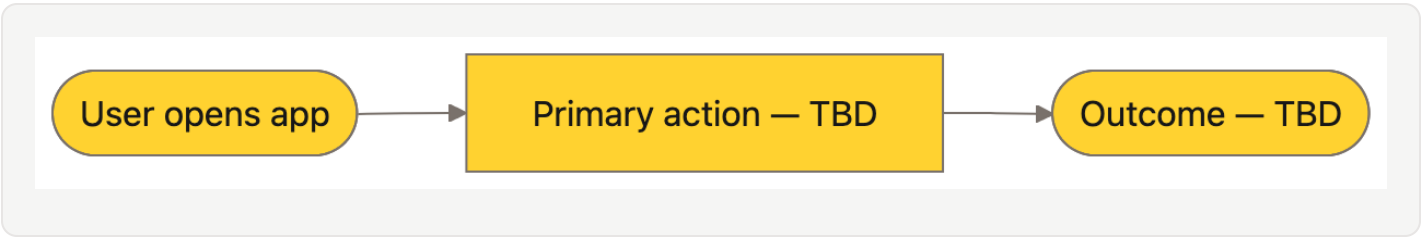
4. Components & Screen Styles

The component inventory and the styles that realize it, built on the tokens. Styles live in `screen.css`; document each component's states (default, hover, focus, disabled, loading, error) and link to its styled-screen example.

Component	States documented	Example
<i>Button</i>	—	—
<i>Input</i>	—	—
<i>Card</i>	—	—

5. User Flows

How users move through the product to accomplish the highest-traffic stories. Mermaid `flowchart` is fine for first-pass; source diagrams live in `flows/`.



6. Wireframes

Low-fidelity layout of each key screen — structure before style. Assets live in `wireframes/` (images or HTML); promote to Figma for anything that will ship.

- *Screen — wireframe link*

7. Styled Screens

High-fidelity screens that apply the design system to the wireframes. HTML mockups in [styled-screens/](#) consume `tokens.css` + `screen.css`, so they double as a visual regression reference and a head-start for `frontend-lead`.

- [Screen — styled-screen link](#)

8. Accessibility

Accessibility is a design responsibility, not a QA afterthought. Document the target and any deliberate exceptions.

Concern	Standard / approach
Color contrast	WCAG AA (4.5:1 text, 3:1 large/UI)
Keyboard	All interactive elements reachable & operable
Screen readers	Semantic markup; labelled controls
Motion	Respect <code>prefers-reduced-motion</code>

9. Open Questions

Unresolved design decisions and assumptions that could be wrong. Drives the next design conversation.

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10. Appendix

Inspiration, references, prior art, links to Figma files.

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10.1 FAQs

Q: How do I add review comments to this design doc?

A: Same as the other docs. Hand-edit `docs/DESIGN/comments.md` with `## §<section-id>` blocks pointing at a section's `id` (e.g. `tokens`, `flows`), or run `/serve-docs DESIGN` and use the inline `+ Comment` widget. Then run `/refine-doc DESIGN` to have the changes applied and the addressed comments removed. The sidebar is gitignored; resolutions land via PR. See `process/WORKFLOW.md` → Doc review loop.

Q: Why is the design system in `docs/DESIGN/` and not in the app's source?

A: It's the design *deliverable* — the contract. During Implement, `frontend-lead` imports or derives the app's real stylesheets from `tokens.css` / `screen.css`. Keeping the canonical system here keeps it reviewable as a doc and decoupled from any one app's build layout.

Q: —

A: —